

Ingram Micro Magix

Got no magic

The Ingram Micro Magix is based on an Intel P4 1.5 GHz processor and has 128 MB SDRAM. It is sturdily built and internally the cables are well laid out. Housed



inside a roomy ATX cabinet, there's ample space for adding extra IDE devices. However, there are no bundled applications.

We tested this PC with Windows XP Home Edition. The performance of its core subsystem (CPU, memory, hard drive and the CD-ROM drive) was tested using SiSoft Sandra Pro, where it logged a poor overall score of 16.9. Its extremely low 8.5 fps in *Quake III Arena* (at 1024x 768x32)

Price: Rs 31,200
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and its failure to run *Evolva Bump Mapped* demo makes it unsuitable for gaming. It took 27.2 seconds for the Photo-shop filter test, proving to be a slow performer in office productivity applications.

This PC comes with a one-year parts replacement warranty and can be serviced in any of 16 service centres across India. But there is no telephonic support or annual maintenance contract.

Because of its poor showing in our tests, even its low price may not be an advantage as there are better performing PCs available at similar prices.

SPECIFICATIONS

P4 1.5 GHz processor, 128 MB SDRAM, Seagate 40 GB 5,400-rpm Hard disk, Via PM4256 chipset motherboard, PS/2 interface keyboard and mouse, Ingram Micro 15-inch monitor supporting 1024x768 at 60 Hz, Philips 320 watts speakers

Ingram Micro Magix		B-
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶	
Build quality	▶▶▶▶▶	
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶	
Features	▶▶▶▶▶	
OVERALL	▶▶▶▶▶	

TVS Proton

Beautifully strong

If you often need to print small bills or an Excel sheet with just a few columns, you must have felt the pinch of wasting a full A4 size page. The TVS Proton takes care of this—an 80-column dot matrix printer allows you to print on conventional continuous sheet, A4 paper or on paper roll of varying sizes. It has a USB as well as serial interface and therefore, can be used with old DOS-based applications and with the latest OSes such as Windows XP, on which we tested the printer.

The installation was easy



and quick, thanks to the USB interface. There's an ink level indicator and the printer has a unique ink bank technology—you can simply replace a small ink tube rather than the entire ink ribbon when it gets fully used.

We tested a few sample test documents with a mix-

ture of text in different font sizes and graphics. It managed to print with good clarity; even 6 point text was clearly readable. While printing one of the graphic elements (a circle with straight lines inside), it managed to print the circle clearly but some of the straight lines inside were jagged.

One shortcoming was that it did not have a power switch button. The only way to switch it off is by unplugging the cable or switching

Price: Rs 8,995
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Busy Lite 3.0

Light and easy

This is an easy-to-use accounting software. We tested it with Windows Me and XP and the installation was pretty smooth. The interface is simple and easy to understand.

We ran the application at 1024x768 resolution and found that it does not use the full screen, which is a bit cumbersome. The data is created in MDF (MS Access) format and is secured—you need to provide a password to access the database. However, the software does not specify a minimum password length, which makes it slightly vulnerable.

Busy Lite 3.0 has quite an exhaustive list of features. To make printing cost-effective on a deskjet or a laserjet, it

off the mains power. There are only two buttons (for form feed and a standby switch) which is a slight handicap when it comes to manageability.

Overall, this printer offers low cost of printing. It has some good features and an excellent build quality.

SPECIFICATIONS

80-column dot matrix printer; supports printing on continuous sheet, A4 paper or on paper roll of varying sizes; USB and serial interface

TVS Proton		B+
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶	
Build quality	▶▶▶▶▶	
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶	
Features	▶▶▶▶▶	
OVERALL	▶▶▶▶▶	

emulates the character-based DOS print mode. It includes utilities such as a calculator, user-definable warning alarms if your account figures go in negative sums, a unit converter and year-wise data backup and restore.

You cannot view the balance sheet by specified date or period—it is displayed only for the whole month or the whole year.

The final word: it is comparatively low priced and its user friendliness makes it suitable for small businesses and professionals.

SPECIFICATIONS

25 MB download size, package includes installation CD, user registration card and mouse pad
System Requirements: Pentium 200 MHz processor, Windows 95/98 SE/Me/2000/XP/NT, 800x600 monitor resolution

Price: Rs 68,500
Contact: Zenith Computers Ltd
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Busy Lite 3.0		B
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶	
Ease of use	▶▶▶▶▶	
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶	
Features	▶▶▶▶▶	
OVERALL	▶▶▶▶▶	